

Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος

Alexander the Ephesian Poet and His Lost Verses

eul_aid: lfy

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)

Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)

Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)

Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

Alexander of Ephesus was a Greek poet and scholar who lived in the 1st century BCE, during the late Hellenistic period. He was a native of the important city of Ephesus in Asia Minor.

According to the ancient geographer Strabo, he was a contemporary of the Roman statesman Cicero and was known for his skill in poetry. He was also a friend of the historian Artemidorus, another Ephesian. Alexander was called a "sophist," a term which at the time often referred to a skilled orator or man of letters who moved in educated, cosmopolitan circles.

His primary known work was a single, now lost, epic poem. Strabo records that Alexander composed this poem in hexameter verse—the meter used by Homer—as a work of praise for the city of Rome. No title or fragments of the poem survive; our entire knowledge of it comes from this brief mention.

Modern scholars see Alexander as a minor but illustrative figure of his era. His decision to write a Greek epic praising Rome represents a significant cultural trend, showing how Greek intellectuals engaged with and adapted to the new political reality of Roman power. His lost work is a data point for understanding the reception of Rome in the Greek East during the final century of the Roman Republic.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα καὶ Τίτλος · [Fragments and Title](#) · 3 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · [Achilles Tattius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς · [Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- Αἴλιος Θεών ὁ σοφιστής · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works
- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · [Amphicrates Atheniensis](#) · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · [Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius](#) · 2 works

- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ῥαμνοῦσιος · Antiphon of Rhamnus · 1 work